



GREY BANNER ALERT



SHW Serious Incident (SI) – Final Notice

Date of Incident	12 January 2026	Time of Incident	09:00
Directorate / Region	OMTID	Main Roads or Contractor	Contractor
EQSafe Event Type	Injury / Illness	EQSafe Incident Number	56032
Actual Consequence	Moderate	Potential Consequence	Major

Incident Short Description	Laceration from Quick Cut Saw
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Executive Summary

- During tie-in works for a storm water pit a worker was cutting out a section of 300mm ID in-situ stormwater pipe.
- The worker commenced cutting out the top half of the 0.75m length of pipe to be removed. The method used required two horizontal and 4 vertical cuts.
- Once these cuts were made an excavator removed the waste material.
- The worker then commenced the 4 vertical cuts on the lower half of the section of pipe.
- While undertaking the fourth and last cut the blade of the saw has jammed creating a kick back event that has resulted in the worker losing control of the saw and the blade impacting him in the upper right chest area.



Recreation of cutting method with arrows showing exact position of cut that caused kick back



Excavation and Pipe Setup

Contributing Factors

- The workpiece being cut was not adequately supported resulting in pipe sagging and pinching the quick cut blade causing kickback.
- The Quick Cut saw being used was not equipped with an anti-kickback blade brake.
- The work crew did not follow Safe Work Method Statement (SWMS) that identifies that in the general operation of the saw when cutting pipework, a pipe cradle is to be used or alternatively the pipe is to be chocked with timber wedges.
- An alternate tool such as a Ring Saw was not considered for the task. This type of equipment would have been suitable as it does not have the inherent risks of a Quick Cut saw incident occurring.
- The involved person IP may not have been aware of the potential for the sections of the pipe to move once cut.
- The drainage Supervisor, a sub-contractor to the Main Contractor was not fully familiar with the Main Contractors' requirements for Trenching and Excavation, specifically the requirement for an initial documented inspection prior to entering and working in a trench or excavation.
- The use and management of Quick Cut saws is not considered in the contractor's Integrated Management system.
- The Project Risk Register did contain controls for the use of a Quick Cut saw however these controls were not cascaded down to the work front.
- To operate a 'Demo Saw' the National Training Matrix mandates HIRAC Level 1 and Construction White Card. There is no training specific to the tool itself. The IP holds the Small Plant and Equipment Use - Quick Cut however the training focused on pavement and slab cutting.

Corrective Actions

- Review the option to add the Quick Cut Saw to the Prohibited and Restricted Items Document in the Main Contractor's Integrated Management system.
- Inspection of all trenches and excavations on site to confirm compliance to the Main Contractor's Safety Management systems requirements.
- Review of Risk Register to remove inconsistencies in controls for the activity of concrete cutting.
- Site wide communications requiring the Main Contractor's organisation to develop and use a task specific Safe Work Method Statement (SWMS) for any concrete cutting / coring activity.
- Confirmation and communication to all projects in the Western Region: Handheld Demolition/Quick Cut Saws confirmed prohibited (option A) or under a mandatory permit with General Manager approval (option B).
- Lessons Learned to be issued and Toolbox developed and rolled out on site outlining investigation findings.
- Trial of tools with brake stop technology to be undertaken in Sub-Contractor's yard.
- Refresher of the Main Contractor's "Operational Minimum Requirements" (OMR) Training for all Supervision on the Project.
- Develop and implement a permit inspection schedule.
- Revisit Emergency Response procedure with Project team to ensure they understand radio protocols and expected actions when an Emergency is called over the radio.

Additional Issues / Learnings

- Eliminate the use of handheld demolition saws wherever possible. The use should be considered as a last resort with risk assessment and additional controls implemented.
- There are models of Quick Cut Saw on the market that possess engineering controls to mitigate the effects of kickback or that do not create the same risk of kickback. These should be considered as part of the risk assessment for upcoming works.

Distribution of Notice

Main Roads Personnel and Contracting Organisations